

6 Songs from A Shropshire Lad

5. The lads in their hundreds

Alfred Edward Housman

George Butterworth

Allegretto, sempre tranquillo e senza rigore

Voice

p

The lads in their hun - dreds to Lud - low come in for the fair, There's

Piano

p sempre

3

men from the barn and the forge and the mill and the fold, — The

6

lads for the girls and the lads for the liqu - or are there, And

8

there with the rest — are the lads — that will ne - ver be

10

old. _____ There's chaps from the town and the

13

field and the till and the cart, And ma - ny to count are the

15

stal - wart, and ma - ny the brave, _____ And

17

ma - ny the hand - some of face and the hand - some of heart, And

19

few that will car - ry their looks ____ or their truth ____ to the

22

grave. ____ I

24

wish one could know them, I wish there were tok - ens to tell The

26

for - tun - ate fel - lows that now you can ne - ver dis - cern; ____ And

29

then one could talk with them friend - ly and wish them fare - well And

31

watch them de - part ____ on the way ____ that they will not re -

33

-turn. ____ But now you may stare as you

36

like and there's noth - ing to scan; And brush - ing your el - bow un -

38

-guessed at and not to be told ____ They car - ry back bright to the

poco allargando

colla voce

41

coin - er the mint - age of man, The lads that will die ____ in their

43

glo - ry and ne - ver be old. ____

a tempo

46

rit.